
Appeal Decisions

Site visit made on 5 August 2026

by **Hannah Guest BSc (Hons) MA MRTPI**

an Inspector appointed by the Secretary of State

Decision date: 14 September 2026

Appeal A Ref: 6011319

Hill House Farm, Bosbury, Ledbury, HR8 1JU

- The appeal is made under section 78 of the Town and Country Planning Act 1990 (as amended) against a refusal to grant planning permission.
 - The appeal is made by Mr & Mrs Corlett against the decision of Herefordshire Council.
 - The application Ref is P253604/FH.
 - The development proposed is Internal and external alterations including single storey extension.
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Appeal B Ref: 6011314

Hill House Farm, Bosbury, Ledbury, HR8 1JU

- The appeal is made under section 20 of the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 (as amended) against a refusal to grant listed building consent.
 - The appeal is made by Mr & Mrs Corlett against the decision of Herefordshire Council.
 - The application Ref is P253605/L.
 - The works proposed are Internal and external alterations including single storey extension.
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Decisions

1. **Appeal A:** The appeal is dismissed.
2. **Appeal B:** The appeal is dismissed.

Preliminary Matters

3. On 17 August 2026, a revised National Planning Policy Framework (the Framework) was published. Parts of the Framework relevant to the appeals were amended. The Council and the appellants were given an opportunity to comment on those amendments during the appeal process. I am therefore satisfied that neither party would be prejudiced by my determining the appeals on that basis.
4. There are two sets of plans before me bearing the same drawing numbers: Crit.1.200 B, Crit.1.201 A, Crit.1.202 B and Crit.1.203 A. The principal differences between them relate to the design of the single-storey extension and the inclusion of a glazed link between the extension and the appeal property. The Council's officer report makes clear that the proposal assessed and refused by the Council included the glazed link. This is also consistent with the appellants' appeals statement, which describes the extension as being 'link detached'. Accordingly, for the avoidance of doubt, I have determined the appeals on the basis of the proposal incorporating the glazed link.
5. In addition, as part of the appeals, the appellants submitted amended plans¹ showing additional timber framing to the north, south and west elevations of the

¹ Drawing Nos: Crit.1 200 C, Crit.1 202 C and Crit.1 203 B

proposed single-storey extension, together with a revised layout for the entrance hall and proposed snug/playroom. I am satisfied that these amendments do not amount to a fundamental change to the proposal. As the Council has had the opportunity to comment on the amended plans, no party would be prejudiced by my determining the appeals on that basis.

6. The appeal property is a listed building. The appeals relate to planning permission and listed building consent for the same site and proposal. To avoid repetition and for the avoidance of doubt, I have considered both appeals together in my reasoning. In determining the appeals, I have had special regard to the desirability of preserving the building or its setting or any features of special architectural or historic interest which it possesses, as required by sections 66(1) and 16(2) of the Planning (Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas) Act 1990 (as amended) (the Act).

Main Issue

7. The main issue in both appeals is whether the proposal would preserve the Grade II listed building, known as Hillhouse, or any features of special architectural or historic interest which it possesses.

Reasons

Special Interest and Significance

8. The Grade II listed building, Hillhouse², is a farmhouse dating from around 1600. It comprises a timber-framed core at its eastern end, arranged in an L-shaped plan with a prominent cross-wing, together with later additions and alterations extending westwards.
9. Constructed principally of timber framing with painted brick and wattle-and-daub infill panels, on a sandstone plinth beneath tiled roofs, the farmhouse displays the characteristics of a high-quality Herefordshire vernacular building. Its architectural interest is evident in the decorative features of the timber framing to the cross-wing, including close-studding and ornamental square panels; the substantial chimney stacks; and the irregular fenestration, which highlights historic alterations to the building.
10. Its significance derives principally from its early core, which reflects the relatively high status of the farmhouse at the time of its construction. The decorative embellishment of the framing distinguishes it from more modest vernacular farmhouses and contributes strongly to its architectural and historic interest.
11. The later additions and alterations are also of heritage interest, illustrating the gradual growth and adaptation of the farmhouse from the 17th century onwards in response to changing agricultural and domestic needs. These elements are generally simpler and more utilitarian in character than the earlier core. In particular, the former granary at the western end of the building reflects its agricultural origins through its more functional design and construction.
12. The architectural and historic interest of the western additions and their contribution to the significance of the listed building as a whole has been compromised to some extent by later alterations, including the conversion of the

² National Heritage List for England. List Entry Number: 1156810.

granary to domestic accommodation in the 1990s, involving the insertion of windows and French doors and the creation of a patio adjoining the west gable end. Nevertheless, the granary's historic character remains readily apparent, particularly in its comparatively plain north elevation, which is notably less domestically influenced than the other façades, and in the survival of the external stone steps. As such, these later additions continue to make a meaningful contribution to the understanding of the farmhouse's historical development.

13. Overall, the significance of Hillhouse, insofar as it relates to these appeals, lies in its preservation of a substantial timber-framed farmhouse of elaborate architectural design. While the highest architectural and historic interest of the listed building may be concentrated within the original seventeenth-century eastern range and cross-wing, the later western additions are also of heritage merit, deriving principally from their evidential value in illustrating the building's historic evolution.

Development and effects

14. Policy HE4 (2) of the Framework sets out that any harm to, or loss of, the significance of a designated heritage asset should have a clear and convincing justification in accordance with the policies in Chapter 20 Conserving and enhancing the historic environment. HE6 (1) goes on to state that when considering the potential effect of a development proposal on the significance of a designated heritage asset, substantial weight should be given to the asset's conservation.
15. The proposal comprises a single-storey extension attached to the west gable end of the listed building by way of a glazed link. The extension would provide a dining room and utility/boot room. As a result, the existing dining room within the former granary would be converted to a kitchen and the existing kitchen would become a snug/playroom and circulation space. The proposal also includes a range of associated internal and external alterations. At first-floor level, the principal bedroom ensuite would be relocated to another bedroom, enabling the existing ensuite to be used as a bedroom. These alterations would also involve the insertion of additional windows.
16. There are several discrepancies between the amended floor plans³ and elevation drawings⁴ relating to the design of the proposed extension. Although the dimensions of the glazed link appear to be consistent on both drawings, the north and south elevations are of a greater length than shown on the floor plans. The elevations also show a different arrangement of openings and glazing, including what appears to be a set of French doors. Whether this element is intended to comprise French doors, as shown on earlier drawings, or a section of timber-framed walling, its scale and configuration do not correspond with the wall section shown on the floor plans.
17. These deficiencies are undesirable in any case, but particularly so given the Grade II listed status of the building. Nonetheless, I have assessed the main elements of the proposal and their effects as far as possible on the basis of the plans and information before me.

³ Drawing No: Crit.1 200 C

⁴ Drawing Nos: Crit.1 202 C and Crit.1 203 B

18. The evidence indicates that the proposed extension would comprise a low stone plinth with timber framing and glazing above, beneath a plain clay tiled roof. It would have a modest footprint relative to the listed building as a whole and would be set back slightly from the north and south elevations. The roof would have a lower ridge and eaves height than the listed building, while reflecting its roof pitch. To facilitate the connection of the extension by the glazed link, the opening currently containing the French doors in the west gable end of the former granary would be widened to create a more open relationship between the proposed kitchen and the dining area within the extension.
19. There are no details before me regarding the form of the structure that would support the glazed link or how it would be attached to the west gable end of the listed building. As proposed, it would result in the loss of an appreciable section of the stone wall forming that gable. The appellants' appeals statement asserts that this part of the wall was reconstructed as part of the alterations to the granary in the mid-1990s. However, no corroborating evidence has been provided. I also note the appellants' contention that a wider opening was approved as part of these alterations. Nonetheless, that opening does not form part of the listed building as it currently exists and the proposal before me would require the further widening of the existing opening. I have therefore assessed the effect of those additional interventions on the significance of the listed building as it presently stands.
20. I recognise the appellants' contention that the proposal has been revised in response to concerns raised by the Council during the pre-application process. Nevertheless, although the proposed extension would continue the established linear form of the listed building, it would project appreciably further beyond it than the former brick extension that has been removed and would extend the building to a greater degree than the addition created through the conversion of the former granary. Consequently, while the extension would remain lower and smaller than the listed building as a whole, the extent to which it would lengthen the building would be out of keeping with the scale of additions that have historically contributed to its evolution, disrupting its historic composition.
21. Furthermore, by virtue of its significant depth and projection, it would compete with the former granary as a subordinate element of the building, diminishing its ability to be appreciated as a distinct phase in the building's evolution. Although the building has previously been extended westwards, the siting of the extension beyond the granary would also weaken the granary's identity as a former agricultural building and reduce the legibility of the listed building's historical development.
22. I have no issue, in principle, with interventions that maintain a clear distinction between new and historic fabric. However, in this case, the large expanse of glazing proposed for the link, combined with its substantially smaller scale in comparison with the two additions it would connect, would appear incongruous.
23. While the proposed extension would use a palette of materials similar to the listed building, even with the additional timber framing, the proportions of the proposed framing would not fully reflect those of the historic timber frame. The absence of horizontal timbers would create larger panels between the framing members, giving the elevations an overly vertical emphasis that would appear at odds with the historic character of the building. As a result, the extension would be unduly

prominent as a distinct element and would lack the deference typically expected of an addition to a listed building.

24. Given the inconsistencies in the plans, the precise pattern of fenestration and extent of glazing remain unclear. Nevertheless, if the amended elevation drawings⁵ are to read as showing a large set of French doors and extensive areas of glazing, these features would appear at odds with the modest and irregular fenestration of the listed building and would risk competing with it for visual attention.
25. The creation of a snug/playroom within the western bay of the entrance hall, together with the enlargement of the WC within the eastern bay, both on the southern side of the building, would alter the proportions of the hall and relocate circulation from its traditional central position to the northern side of the building. The evidence indicates that the entrance hall has for some time been subdivided, with the two bays becoming increasingly separate, particularly following the conversion of the granary, which opened the western bay into the converted accommodation. Nonetheless, the central circulation route has continued to provide a unifying element. While the amended plans would create a single room within the western bay and would no longer impinge on the historic beam spanning it, the relocation of circulation to the north would further erode the legibility of the entrance hall as a coherent whole. This harm to the legibility of the historic plan form would be compounded by the creation of the larder, which would alter the historic proportions of the former granary.
26. The reconfiguration of the entrance hall would involve the removal and insertion of internal walls. I saw on my visit that much of the fabric proposed for removal comprises relatively modern stud partitions installed around the historic timber frame. However, it is unclear from the information before me how the removal of these partitions would affect the historic fabric. For example, the details do not make clear how the proposal would relate to the timber brace adjacent to the external doorway on the northern elevation, nor whether alterations to the surrounding partitions would affect it.
27. Although I share the Council's view that the reconfiguration of the WC would improve the legibility of the historic plan form, there is limited information regarding how the proposed stud walls, repositioned sink and associated drainage would be installed or integrated with the existing historic fabric. Limited information has also been provided regarding the proposed ventilation duct for the larder, including the extent of any historic fabric that would be lost or affected and the size, detailing and precise position of the external vent within the masonry; and the first-floor alterations, including the relocation of the ensuite bathroom. As the Council has identified, clearer and more comprehensive information is required to support these proposed interventions, including a schedule of works, drainage and services drawings, and method statements.
28. While the modest scale and positioning of the additional first-floor windows suggest that they would sit comfortably within the existing organic pattern of fenestration, there are no detailed elevation or sectional drawings before me showing their detailed design, profile or method of installation. Similar considerations apply to the replacement of the existing doors with timber-panelled

⁵ Drawing Nos: Crit.1 202 C and Crit.1 203 B

doors and the addition of modest gable-end porches. No details have been provided regarding these interventions. Consequently, their effect on the listed building and its significance cannot be robustly assessed.

29. The same concern applies to a number of other elements of the proposal, where there is a significant lack of detail. These include the installation of underfloor heating within the former granary and any associated changes to floor levels; alterations to the steps leading to the kitchen on the north side of the building and the blocking up of the external kitchen door; the enlargement of the ground-floor window in the south elevation of the granary; the replacement of the external door adjacent to the southern chimney stack with a window; and the renewal of modern windows. These elements may be modest individually but, collectively, form part of the overall package of proposed alterations to the listed building. In the absence of detailed drawings, specifications and method statements, their effect on the listed building and its significance cannot be robustly assessed.
30. The onus rests with the appellants to provide sufficiently detailed and accurate information to demonstrate that the proposal would preserve the special interest of the listed building and not harm its significance. In the absence of that information, I cannot be confident that it would do so. Although the appellants have expressed a willingness to accept conditions requiring further details, the deficiencies identified relate to fundamental aspects of the proposed development and works and their effect on significance. They are therefore not matters that could reasonably be left to conditions.
31. Taking all of the above into account, I find that the proposal would result in harmful interventions and alterations to important aspects and features that contribute to the listed building's special interest and significance. In particular, the proposed single-storey extension, the interventions to the western gable end required to create the glazed link, the reconfiguration of the entrance hall and the creation of the snug/playroom would weaken the integrity and legibility of the listed building and its historic development.
32. Furthermore, the absence of sufficient information regarding several other elements of the proposal means that I cannot be satisfied that those works and development would preserve the special interest and not harm the significance of the listed building. Consequently, based on the information before me and my observations on site, I conclude that the proposal would fail to preserve the Grade II listed building, Hillhouse, and features of special architectural or historic interest that it possesses. As such, the proposal would harm the significance of this designated heritage asset.

Public benefits and heritage balance

33. The proposal would not result in the loss of the principal elements that contribute most strongly to the significance of the listed building, including its early timber-framed core and decorative framing. Nonetheless, it would affect several important aspects of significance, including the legibility of the building's historic development, the integrity of the former granary as a distinct phase in that development, and the historic plan form of the entrance hall. Consequently, I find that it would result in a moderate level of harm to the significance of the designated heritage asset. I afford this matter considerable importance and weight.

34. Policy HE6 (4) of the Framework requires this harm to be weighed against any public benefits resulting from the proposal. Important public benefits can include securing the long-term reuse of a vacant or underused listed building, and enabling energy efficiency and low carbon heating measures to be employed.
35. The proposal would give rise to economic benefits during the construction phase, social benefits through a modest enhancement to the local housing stock, as well as limited enhancements arising from the removal of later additions and alterations to the listed building. However, given the limited scale of the development and works, and the nature of the alterations, I afford these benefits modest weight.
36. Policy CC2 (2) of the Framework affords substantial weight to the benefits of improving the energy efficiency of existing buildings. However, while the proposed extension may incorporate an energy efficient specification and a design that encourages passive solar gain, this would not improve the energy efficiency of the existing building. Consequently, I afford this benefit limited weight. Similarly, although the proposed renewal of the modern windows has the potential to improve the energy efficiency of the building, given the lack of detail regarding this intervention, I can only afford any associated heritage or environmental benefits limited weight.
37. The appellants assert that the proposed extension and associated internal alterations would be reversible and could be removed in the future without lasting alteration to the building or disruption to its historic core. I acknowledge that reversibility can reduce the permanence of an intervention. However, heritage significance is experienced in the present, and the proposal would nonetheless affect important aspects of the listed building's significance for as long as it remained in place. Moreover, given the absence of detailed information regarding several elements of the proposed development and works, I cannot be confident that all of the interventions would be undertaken without lasting effects on the historic fabric. Consequently, I afford this matter limited weight in favour of the proposal.
38. The appellants also contend that the proposed development and works are focused within the part of the listed building of least architectural and historic significance and would concentrate the main domestic living functions within that area. I acknowledge that the western additions, including the former granary, are of less architectural and historic interest than the seventeenth-century core of the building and that directing change towards less sensitive areas is generally preferable to interventions affecting the most significant fabric. Nevertheless, the western additions remain an important component of the listed building's significance and make a meaningful contribution to an understanding of its historic development. For the reasons set out above, the proposal would weaken the legibility and integrity of those elements. Accordingly, while I acknowledge the merits of directing change towards the less sensitive parts of the building, the proposal would nevertheless undermine the contribution that those elements make to the building's significance and would therefore be harmful overall.
39. The additional space and reconfiguration of the accommodation would principally serve the private interests of the occupiers. I recognise that Hillhouse has evolved over time in response to the needs of successive generations and that the appellants seek to adapt the building to better meet their domestic requirements. However, the desire to secure a more convenient or desirable arrangement of

accommodation does not, in itself, justify development and works that would fail to conserve the listed building in a manner commensurate with its significance. Accordingly, I afford this matter very limited weight in favour of the proposal.

40. Furthermore, there is no substantive evidence before me to demonstrate that the proposal is the only means of meeting the appellants' accommodation needs or securing the benefits that have been identified. Nor is there any evidence that the proposed development and works are necessary to secure the contemporary or continued residential use of the listed building, or that dismissal of the appeals would place the conservation of the designated heritage asset at risk. Consequently, I find that clear and convincing justification for the harm to the significance of the listed building has not been provided.
41. Taking all matters into account, I conclude that the public benefits of the proposal would be insufficient to outweigh the considerable importance and weight I afford to the moderate harm I have identified to the significance of the listed building.
42. Accordingly, the proposal would conflict with sections 66(1) and 16(2) of the Act and the provisions within the Framework which seek to conserve and enhance the historic environment. It would also conflict with Policy LD4 of the Herefordshire Local Plan Core Strategy 2011-2031 (2015), which seeks to protect, conserve, and where possible enhance heritage assets in a manner appropriate to their significance through appropriate management, uses and sympathetic design, in particular emphasising the original form and function where possible.

Other Matters

43. I note that the Council's Ecologist advised that further assessment may be required in respect of Great Crested Newts and suggested that this could potentially be secured by pre-commencement condition. Had I been minded to allow the appeal against the refusal of planning permission, I would have sought the parties' views on whether such an approach would be acceptable, having regard to paragraph 99 of Circular 06/2005⁶. However, as I am dismissing the appeals for other reasons, it is unnecessary for me to reach a conclusion on this.

Overall Balance and Conclusions

44. Policy S3(1) of the Framework requires decisions on development proposals to apply a presumption in favour of sustainable development. In this case, Policy S5 is relevant and states that only certain forms of development should be approved outside settlements, which are set out in a closed list. These should be approved, unless the benefits of doing so would be substantially outweighed by any adverse effects, when assessed against the national decision-making policies in this Framework.
45. The list includes at criterion (c) the reuse, extension, alteration or replacement of an existing building, provided that the existing building is of permanent and substantial construction, is lawful in planning terms, and any extension or alteration will not result in a disproportionate increase in size compared to the existing building. While I have found that the proposed extension would be out of keeping with the scale of additions that have historically formed part of its

⁶ Circular 06/2005: Biodiversity and Geological Conservation – Statutory Obligations and Their Impact Within the Planning System (2005)

evolution, it would not result in a disproportionate increase in size compared to the existing building as a whole.

46. The proposal would give rise to the benefits identified above. Taken together, these weigh modestly in favour of the development.
47. Set against these benefits, I have concluded that the proposed development and works would fail to preserve the Grade II listed building, Hillhouse, and any features of special architectural or historic interest which it possesses, resulting in harm to its significance.
48. The Framework makes clear that substantial weight should be afforded to the conservation of designated heritage assets and that any harm to their significance is a matter of considerable importance and weight. It also indicates that proposals should be refused where, in the absence of clear justification, they fail to respond appropriately to their context.
49. Accordingly, I find that the benefits of approving the proposal would be substantially outweighed by the identified adverse effects, when assessed against the national decision-making policies in the Framework.
50. **Appeal A:** The proposal would conflict with the development plan and material considerations do not indicate that the appeal should be determined other than in accordance with it. Therefore, for the reasons given above, Appeal A should be dismissed.
51. **Appeal B:** For the reasons given above, Appeal B should be dismissed and listed building consent refused.

Hannah Guest

INSPECTOR